



The 90-Day AI Team Transformation Playbook

Empowering teams to discover and leverage their latent AI capabilities

Prompt Advisers



Table Of Contents

The Truth Nobody Tells You	4
The Five People on Your Team (And What They Need)	6
Days 1-30: Surface the Underground	9
Days 31-60: Make It Official	13
Days 61-90: Scale What Works	20
The Truth Nobody Tells You	26
The Five People on Your Team (And What They Need)	27
Days 1-30: Surface the Underground	29
Days 31-60: Make It Official	31
Days 61-90: Scale What Works	34
The Hackathon Playbook: Everything You Need	38

Building Your Incentive Stack	42
The Tactics That Actually Work	47
The Psychology Hacks That Drive Adoption	50
Common Fails and How to Avoid Them	52
Your Monday Morning Action Plan	55
The Only Measurement That Matters	58
The Real Secret	60
Start Tomorrow	62
Appendix: Templates You Can Steal	64



01

The Truth Nobody Tells You

Your team is already using AI. Right now, 70% of them have ChatGPT open in another tab. They're just hiding it from you because they think it makes them look lazy.

Meanwhile, you're planning some big AI transformation, hiring consultants, and buying enterprise licenses for tools nobody wants.

Stop. This playbook shows you how to transform the shadow AI economy already thriving in your company into official innovation -- in 90 days, without consultants.

02

The Five People on Your Team (And What They Need)

1. The Secret Ninja (30% of your team)

- Using ChatGPT through personal email
- Has 47 custom prompts saved in a Google Doc
- Getting 3x more done than everyone else
- Terrified you'll find out

What they need: Permission to come out of hiding. Give them amnesty and make them your champion.

2. The Burned Skeptic (25% of your team)

- Tried ChatGPT once in 2023
- It gave them bad information
- Now tells everyone "AI doesn't work"
- Actually just scared of looking stupid

What they need: One task that saves them 2 hours. Start with their most annoying weekly task and solve it in front of them.



3. The Eager Disaster (20% of your team)

- Uses AI for everything
- No quality control
- Probably putting customer data into ChatGPT
- Hearts in the right place, brain is not

What they need: Clear boundaries and proper tools. Channel their enthusiasm with official accounts and training.

4. The Terrified Replaceable (15% of your team)



- Convinced AI will take their job
- Actively sabotaging AI initiatives
- Spreading fear to others
- Usually your most experienced people

What they need: Show them how AI makes them MORE valuable, not less. Have them train the AI on their expertise.

5. The Overwhelmed Overthinker (10% of your team)

- Has read 500 articles about AI
- Paralyzed by options
- Asks "but which AI should we use?" constantly
- Never actually tries anything

What they need: One tool. One use case. No options. Just start.

03

Days 1-30: Surface the Underground



Week 1: The Amnesty Declaration

Monday: Send this email:

"We know many of you are using AI tools to get work done. That's smart. For the next 2 weeks, tell us what you're using and how -- no judgment, no punishment. We want to learn from you."

Wednesday: Anonymous survey with THREE questions:

1. Which AI tools do you use? (List them all)
2. What tasks do you use them for?
3. How many hours per week do they save you?

Friday: Share the results publicly. People will be shocked how much AI is already happening.

Week 2: Find Your Champions

Look for these signs:

- Finishing projects suspiciously fast
- Email quality suddenly improved
- Never complains about routine tasks anymore
- Has strong opinions about Claude vs ChatGPT



Approach them privately: "I know you're using AI. That's great. Want to help others do the same?"

Week 3: The Confession Sessions

Host "AI Show and Tell" -- 15 minutes, twice this week:

- Champion shows ONE thing they automated
- Demonstrates the before (2 hours) and after (10 minutes)
- Answers questions for 5 minutes
- No slides. No theory. Just "watch me do this."

Week 4: Quick Wins Only

Give everyone ONE task to automate:

- Email drafts
- Meeting summaries
- Data analysis
- Document review
- Research tasks

Rule: If it takes more than 30 minutes to set up, skip it.

Milestone Check: By Day 30, you should have:

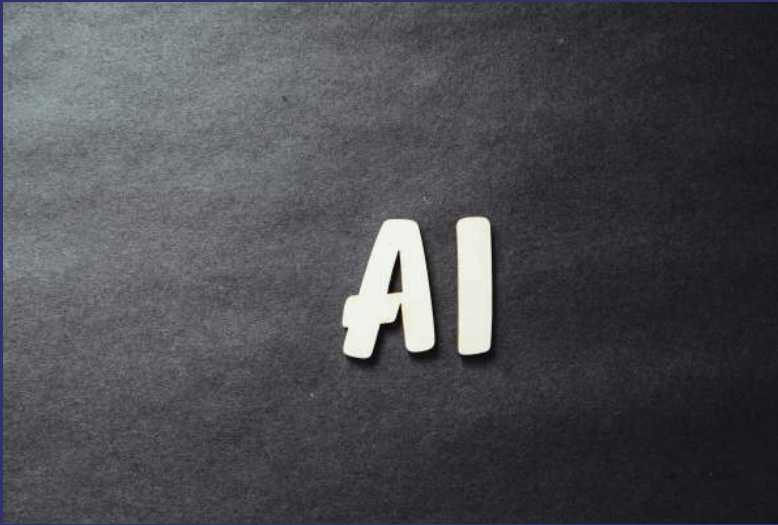
- ✓ **List of all shadow AI usage**
- ✓ **3-5 identified champions**
- ✓ **Everyone has tried AI once**
- ✓ **At least 10 success stories documented**

04

Days 31-60: Make It Official

Week 5-6: Give Them Real Tools

Stop fighting the shadow usage. Legitimize it:



- Get ChatGPT Team or Enterprise (starts at \$25/user/month)
- Or Claude for Business
- Or Microsoft Copilot if you're already in that ecosystem

Don't overthink this. Pick one and move on.

Week 7: The Skill Split

Create THREE learning tracks (people choose their level):

Scared Beginners (2 hours):

- How to write a basic prompt
- How to not put secrets into AI
- One task they can automate today

Secret Users (2 hours):

- Advanced prompting
- Custom GPTs/Agents
- Workflow automation

Future Champions (4 hours):

- Train them to train others
- Complex automation
- Integration with existing tools

Week 8: Launch Your First AI Hackathon

This is where momentum becomes viral. Here's exactly how to run one that works:

The 4-Hour Friday Hackathon

Why Friday afternoon: People are mentally done with real work anyway. Make it feel like sanctioned fun, not extra work.

Structure that actually works:

- 2:00-2:15 PM: Kickoff in main room
- 2:15-3:30 PM: Teams work (maximum 3 people per team)
- 3:30-4:00 PM: Demo time (3 minutes per team)
- 4:00-4:30 PM: Voting, awards, and beers

The rules that matter:

1. Must solve a real problem someone has THIS WEEK
2. Must use AI (any tool, their choice)
3. Must work in 90% of cases (perfection kills shipping)
4. Must be demoable in 3 minutes

What NOT to do:

- Don't assign teams -- let people self-organize
- Don't pick the problems -- let teams pick their own annoyances
- Don't require working code -- a great prompt chain is fine
- Don't make it competitive to the point people won't share

Incentives That Actually Drive Participation

Forget gift cards and plaques. Here's what people actually want:

Immediate Rewards (Day of hackathon):

- **Winner:** Gets to pick the next team lunch spot + \$100 to test any AI tool
- **Runner up:** Gets one "no meetings" day next week
- **People's choice:** Gets to name the AI Slack channel and be mod

The real incentive structure: Give winners the thing everyone wants -- TIME:

- 4 hours per week for 1 month to build out their solution
- Direct access to skip IT approval for AI tool purchases under \$500
- First access to any new AI tools the company trials

Why this works: You're not paying them to participate. You're removing barriers to let them solve their own problems. Massive difference psychologically.

Real Examples from Companies That Nailed It

Example 1: Marketing Agency (47 people)

- Problem picked: Client reporting takes 6 hours every Monday
- Solution built: GPT that reads analytics exports and writes first draft
- Time at hackathon: 3.5 hours
- Weekly time saved: 4 hours per account manager (8 people)
- ROI: 32 hours/week saved = \$64,000 annual value
- What happened next: Became official process in 2 weeks

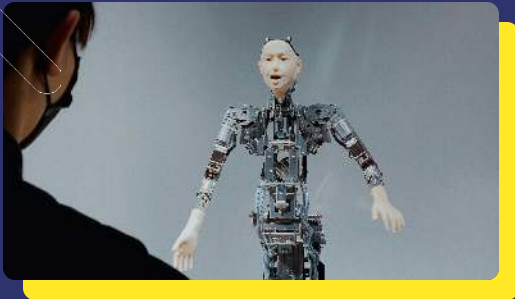


Example 2: SaaS Startup (112 people)

- Problem picked: Support tickets take forever to categorize
- Solution built: Claude API that pre-tags tickets with 90% accuracy
- Time at hackathon: 4 hours (including pizza break)
- Daily time saved: 2 hours for support team
- What happened next: CTO approved production build immediately

Example 3: Law Firm (28 people)

- Problem picked: Contract review for standard terms
- Solution built: Custom GPT trained on their 10 most common contracts
- Time at hackathon: Literally one afternoon
- Per contract time saved: 45 minutes on first pass
- What happened next: Senior partner became biggest AI advocate



Week 8 (continued): Address the Fears Head-On

Hold a "Real Talk" session:

- "Will AI take my job?" No, but someone using AI might.
- "Is it cheating?" No, it's like using spell check.
- "What if it's wrong?" You check it, like any tool.
- "Can I trust it with data?" Here's what's safe and what's not.

Milestone Check: By Day 60, you should have:

- ☒ Official AI tools deployed
- ☒ Everyone trained at their level
- ☒ Clear usage guidelines
- ☒ 50% daily active usage
- ☒ First successful hackathon with 3+ solutions built

05

Days 61-90: Scale What Works



Week 9-10: Measure the Right Things

Track what matters:

- Hours saved per week (target: 4+ hours)
- Tasks automated (target: 3 per person)
- Quality improvements (fewer errors, better output)

Ignore vanity metrics:

- Number of AI interactions
- Amount of data processed
- How many features they use

Week 11: The Monthly Hackathon Rhythm

Now that the first one worked, make it monthly. But evolve the format:

Month 2: The Department Challenge

Each department gets 2 hours to solve their worst problem:

- Sales might automate lead qualification
- HR might build an onboarding bot
- Finance might automate expense categorization

Structure:



- First Friday of month, 2-5 PM
- Departments compete but must share solutions
- Winner gets to "loan" their champion to other departments

Month 3: The Integration Hackathon

Focus on connecting AI to existing tools:

- Slack bots that actually help
- Sheets that update themselves
- Emails that draft themselves

This is where IT should actually show up and help, not block.



Week 12: Build Your Incentive Engine

The Three-Tier Incentive System That Creates Adoption

Tier I: Individual Incentives (Daily/Weekly)

- **"Time Saved Leaderboard"**: Public dashboard showing who saved the most time this week
- **"First to Five"**: First person to automate 5 tasks gets half day Friday off
- **"Solution of the Week"**: Best automation gets featured in all-hands, creator gets \$50 Amazon card

Real example: One company tracked "minutes saved" on a TV dashboard in the office. Became oddly competitive. People started competing to automate more. Genius move: they counted "minutes saved for others" double, which encouraged people to share solutions.

Tier 2: Team Incentives (Monthly)

- "Department of the Month": Highest AI adoption percentage gets catered lunch
- "Automation Olympics": Departments compete in specific challenges:
 - Marketing vs Sales: Who can automate customer communications better?
 - Engineering vs Product: Who can automate status reports better?
 - Prize: Winning team gets first dibs on new AI tools budget

Why this works: Nobody wants their department to be "the one that doesn't get AI." Peer pressure > management pressure.

Tier 3: Company Incentives (Quarterly) Set a big goal everyone can work toward:

- "If we save 1,000 hours this quarter, everyone gets an extra PTO day"
- "If 80% of company uses AI weekly, we close office early every Friday in summer"
- "If we automate 50 workflows, company pays for everyone's ChatGPT personal account"

The Psychology Behind It:

- Individual incentives create starting momentum
- Team incentives create peer accountability
- Company incentives create shared mission

What NOT to incentivize:

- Don't reward just usage -- reward VALUE created
- Don't make it so competitive people hide solutions
- Don't incentivize complexity -- simple automations that work > complex ones that might

Alternative Incentives for Different Cultures

For Startups (Move fast, break things):

- "Ship Friday": Every Friday 2-4 PM is for shipping AI experiments
- "10% Time": Like Google's 20% but specifically for AI automation
- "Demo or Die": Monthly all-hands where people demo or explain why not

06

The Truth Nobody Tells You

07

The Five People on Your Team (And What They Need)

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(30% of your team)**
- 2. The Burned Skeptic
(25% of your team)**
- 3. The Eager Disaster
(20% of your team)**
- 4. The Terrified
Replaceable (15% of
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- 5. The Overwhelmed
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08

Days 1-30: Surface the Underground

Week 1: The Amnesty Declaration

Week 2: Find Your Champions

Week 3: The Confession Sessions

Week 4: Quick Wins Only



09

Days 31-60: Make It Official

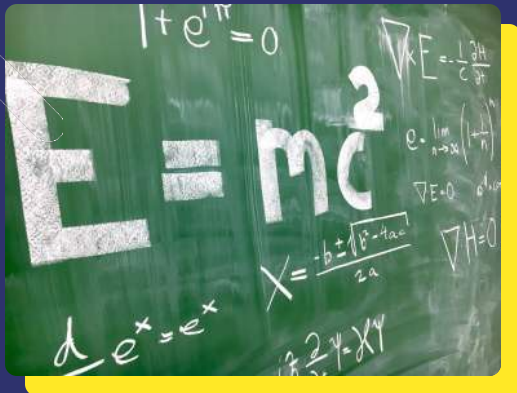
**Week 5-6: Give Them
Real Tools**

Week 7: The Skill Split

**Week 8: Launch Your
First AI Hackathon**

**The 4-Hour Friday
Hackathon**

**Incentives That
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Participation**





Real Examples from Companies That Nailed It

Week 8 (continued): Address the Fears Head-On

10

Days 61-90: Scale What Works

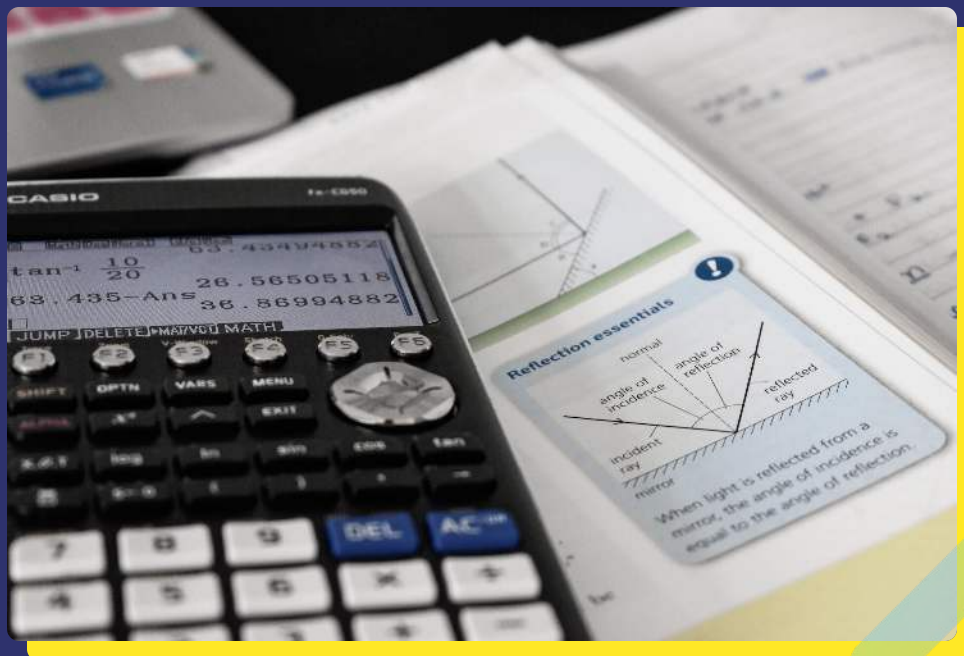
Week 9-10: Measure the Right Things

Week 11: The Monthly Hackathon Rhythm

Month 2: The Department Challenge

Month 3: The Integration Hackathon

Week 12: Build Your Incentive Engine



The Three-Tier Incentive System That Creates Adoption

For Enterprises (More structure needed):



Alternative Incentives for Different Cultures

- Innovation credits: Employees earn credits for AI solutions, redeem for training/conferences
- Patent program: File patents for novel AI applications (IBM does this)
- Career pathway: Create "AI Champion" as official role with advancement path

For Remote Teams (Harder to create energy):

- Async hackathons: 48 hours to submit solutions
- Time zone battles: Americas vs Europe vs Asia
- Virtual coffee: Weekly 15-min session where someone shares an AI win

Week 12-13: Celebrate and Solidify

Share wins publicly:

- "Sarah saved 8 hours this week using Claude for reports"
- "Marketing doubled output without adding headcount"
- "Customer response time down 50% using AI drafts"

Create the new normal:

- AI use becomes expected, not exceptional
- Include AI methods in project planning
- Budget for AI tools like you budget for software

Final Milestone Check:

By Day 90, you should have:

- ☒ 70%+ regular AI usage
- ☒ 20+ hours saved per person monthly
- ☒ 3 monthly hackathons completed
- ☒ Clear incentive system driving adoption
- ☒ AI is now "how we work"



II

The Hackathon Playbook: Everything You Need

Pre-Hackathon Setup (1 week before)

Monday before: Send teaser email: "This Friday: solve your most annoying problem with AI. Pizza included."

Wednesday before:

- Book room with good screens for demos
- Order food (pizza is fine, fancy is unnecessary)
- Set up Slack channel #ai-hackathon
- Create simple voting form (Google Form works)

Thursday before: Send reminder with:

- Time and place
- "Bring your worst problem"
- "No coding required"
- "Prizes are TIME not THINGS"

The Facilitator Script That Works:

During the Hackathon

2:00 PM – Kickoff "Welcome to our first AI hackathon. The rules are simple:

1. Pick something that annoys you every week
2. Try to automate it with AI
3. Show us what you built
4. Best solution gets 4 hours per week to build it properly

You have 90 minutes. Go."

3:30 PM – Demo time "3 minutes per team. Show the problem, show the solution, show the time saved. No slides. Just screen share."

4:15 PM – Voting "Everyone votes for two: Most time saved, and most creative. You can't vote for yourself."

Post-Hackathon (The crucial part)

Monday after:

- Email winners publicly
- Schedule build-out time for winners
- Share all solutions in Slack
- Ask: "Who wants to run next month's?"

Two weeks after:

- Check in on implementation
- Document what shipped
- Calculate actual time saved
- Share ROI with leadership

Common Hackathon Failures and Fixes

Fail: Nobody shows up

Fix: Make it during work hours, not after. Provide food. Make it clear it's encouraged, not extra.

Fail: Only techies participate

Fix: Explicitly say "no coding required" and show examples of prompt chains and no-code solutions.

Fail: Solutions never get implemented

Fix: Winner's prize is TIME to implement, not a gift card to forget about it.

Fail: Same people win every time

Fix: Previous winners become judges/mentors, can't win twice in a row.





12

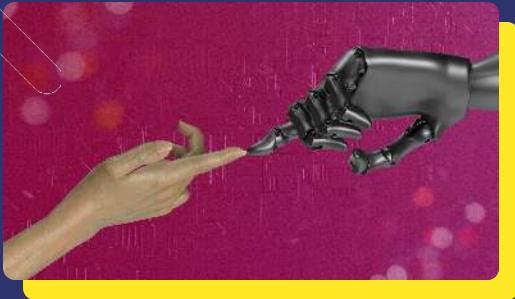
Building Your Incentive Stack

The Psychology of AI Incentives

Most companies focus on #2 (training) and forget #1 and #3. Incentives fix #3 and demonstrate #1.

People need three things to adopt AI:

1. Permission (it's okay to use this)
2. Capability (I know how to use this)
3. Motivation (I want to use this)





The Incentive Menu (Pick 3-5 that fit your culture)

Time Incentives (Most valuable)

- "No Meeting Wednesdays" for top AI adopters
- "Flex Fridays" -- leave at 3 PM if you automated something this week
- "Innovation Hours" -- 4 hours/week to work on AI projects
- "Skip the Status" -- automated reporting = skip the meeting

Recognition Incentives (Most scalable)

- "AI Champion" badge in email signature
- Monthly spotlight in company newsletter
- "Wall of Automation" -- physical or virtual
- Direct recognition from CEO in all-hands

Access Incentives (Most desired)

- First access to new AI tools
- Increased API/usage limits
- Direct line to IT for approvals
- Beta tester status for new features



Growth Incentives (Most strategic)

- Conference passes for AI events
- Online course budgets
- Certification support
- Mentorship opportunities

Fun Incentives (Most viral)

- Name the AI tools/bots
- Design the AI mascot
- Pick the hackathon themes
- Choose team lunch spots

Real ROI Calculations to Justify Incentives

Example: 50-person company

- Average salary: \$70,000 = \$35/hour
- Target: Save 4 hours/week per person
- Weekly savings: 200 hours × \$35 = \$7,000
- Annual savings: \$364,000

Investment needed:

- ChatGPT Enterprise: \$30/user/month = \$18,000/year
- Hackathon costs: \$500/month = \$6,000/year
- Incentives budget: \$1,000/month = \$12,000/year
- Total investment: \$36,000

ROI: 10x in year one

Use this math to get budget approved instantly.



13

The Tactics That Actually Work

The \$300 Experiment Budget

Give everyone \$300 to spend on AI tools/training. No approval needed. They just have to share what they learned. This works because:

- Removes the "I need permission" barrier
- Creates ownership
- Generates 50+ experiments for \$15K
- Surface the best tools organically

The "AI Amnesty Hour"

Every Friday, 3-4pm: Bring your AI mistakes. Share what went wrong. Laugh about it. Learn from it. This removes the fear of failure that kills adoption.

The Shadow to Light Pipeline

1. Discover what people are doing in secret
2. Make it official with proper tools
3. Share their methods with everyone
4. They become the expert/trainer
5. Recognition and advancement follows

The Anti-Playbook Playbook

- No 200-page strategy documents
- No six-month planning cycles
- No steering committees
- No change management consultants
- No mandatory training everyone sleeps through

Just: Find what's working. Do more of it. Share it. Repeat.

14

The Psychology Hacks That Drive Adoption

Create FOMO, Not Force

Don't: "Everyone must use AI by Q2" Do: "Sarah just automated her entire weekly report in 10 minutes"

Solve Their Personal Hell

Everyone has that one task they hate. Find it. Kill it with AI. They'll become believers.

The Champion Effect

When the most respected person on the team uses AI, everyone follows. Find that person. Convert them first.

Permission Structure

People need to hear: "It's okay to use AI" + "It's okay to make mistakes" + "It's okay to save time"

The 10-Minute Rule

If someone can't see value in 10 minutes, you've picked the wrong use case. Start smaller.

15

Common Fails and How to Avoid Them

Fail: Starting with Complex Use Cases

Fix: First AI project should save 2 hours, not transform the business

Fail: IT Lock-Down Mode

Fix: Security matters, but not at the cost of all momentum. Start with non-sensitive tasks.

Fail: Training Everyone the Same

Fix: Scared people need safety. Power users need advanced features. Don't mix them.

Fail: Waiting for Perfect



Fix: 70% good enough today beats 100% perfect in 6 months

Fail: Tool Obsession

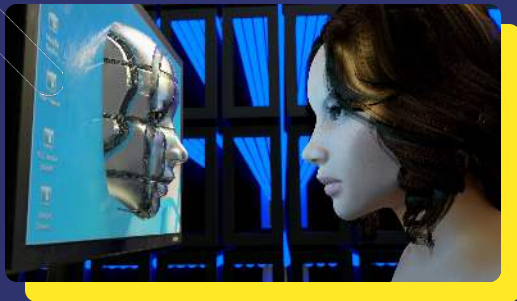
Fix: The best AI tool is the one people actually use. Usually that's ChatGPT or Claude. Start there.

Fail: Weak Incentives

Fix: \$50 gift cards don't change behavior. Time off does. Access does. Recognition does.

Fix: Monthly rhythm creates culture. One-off creates a memory.

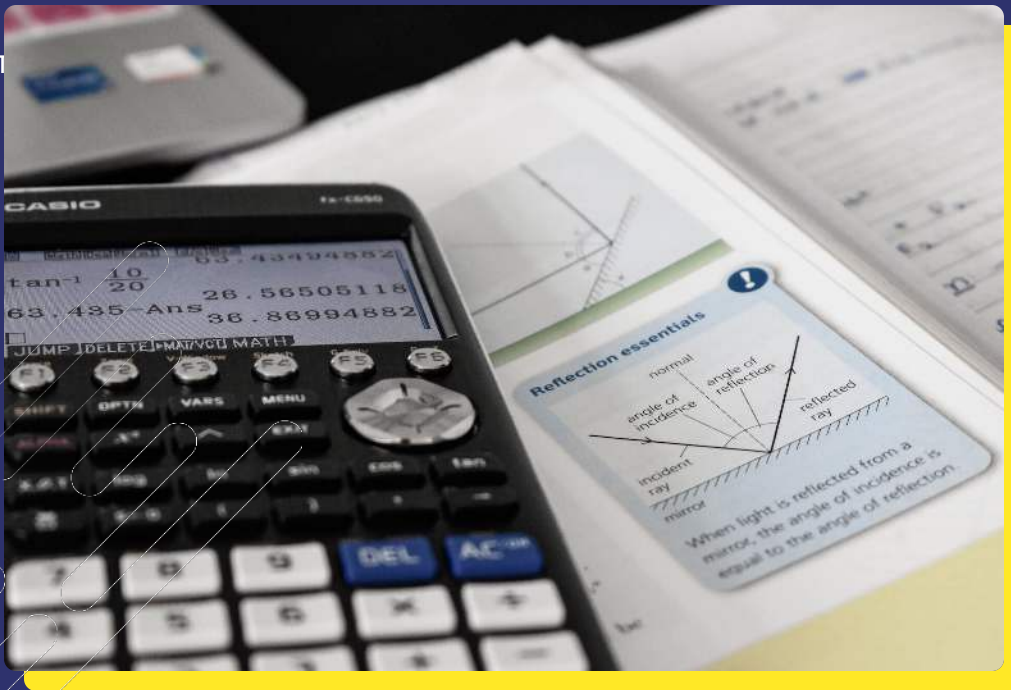
Fail: One and Done Hackathons





16

Your Monday Morning Action Plan



If you have 30 minutes:

1. Send the amnesty email
2. Schedule one "AI Show and Tell"
3. Find one champion

If you have 2 hours:

1. Run the anonymous survey
2. Get budget approval for ChatGPT Team
3. Identify everyone's most hated task
4. Schedule your first Friday hackathon

If you have a day:

1. All of the above
2. Set up trials of 3 AI tools
3. Create Slack channel for AI wins
4. Document 5 current use cases
5. Design your incentive stack
6. Book room for hackathon



17

The Only Measurement That Matters

After 90 days, ask one question: "Is your work better and easier than it was 3 months ago?"

If 70% say yes, you've succeeded. If not, you focused on the wrong things.



18

The Real Secret

Your team doesn't resist AI. They resist:

- Being judged for using it
- Being replaced by it
- Being forced to use it wrong
- Being slower while learning it
- Being punished for mistakes

Remove these five fears, and adoption happens naturally.

You don't need consultants. You don't need a transformation. You need permission, safety, and a few early wins.

The rest takes care of itself.



19

Start Tomorrow

- 
1. Look for the signs: Who's suddenly more productive? They're your secret AI users.
 2. Give permission: "I know you're using AI. That's smart. Show me how."
 3. Share the win: "Look what Sarah figured out. Who wants to learn?"
 4. Remove barriers: "Here's a real account. Stop using your personal email."
 5. Let it spread: Organic beats forced. Every time.
 6. Schedule that hackathon: Seriously. This Friday, 2-5 PM. Pizza. Problems. Prizes.

Your team is already on the journey. Stop planning the trip and start walking with them.

Remember: The best AI transformation is the one that's already happening. You just need to get out of the way -- and occasionally throw a hackathon with good pizza.

20

Appendix: Templates You Can Steal

Hackathon Announcement Email

Subject: This Friday: Kill your most annoying task with AI

You know that thing you do every week that makes you want to scream? Let's automate it.

Friday, 2-5 PM, Conference Room A Bring your laptop and your worst problem.

We'll provide:

- Pizza and drinks
- AI tools access
- Help from people who've done this before

Best solution gets 4 hours/week for a month to build it out properly. Second place gets a "no meetings" day next week.

No coding required. No experience needed. Just frustration with manual work.

RSVP by Wednesday so we know how much pizza to order.

Champion Recruitment Message

Hey [Name],

I've noticed you've been crushing it lately with your output. I suspect you might be using some AI tools to help?

That's awesome -- we want more people doing exactly that.

Would you be up for showing a few people your workflow? Nothing formal, just 15 minutes of "here's how I do this now."

In exchange, you get first access to our new ChatGPT Enterprise accounts and 4 hours a week to experiment with new AI stuff.

Interested?

Incentive Announcement

Team,

Starting Monday, we're tracking time saved through AI automation.

Why? Because we want to celebrate it.

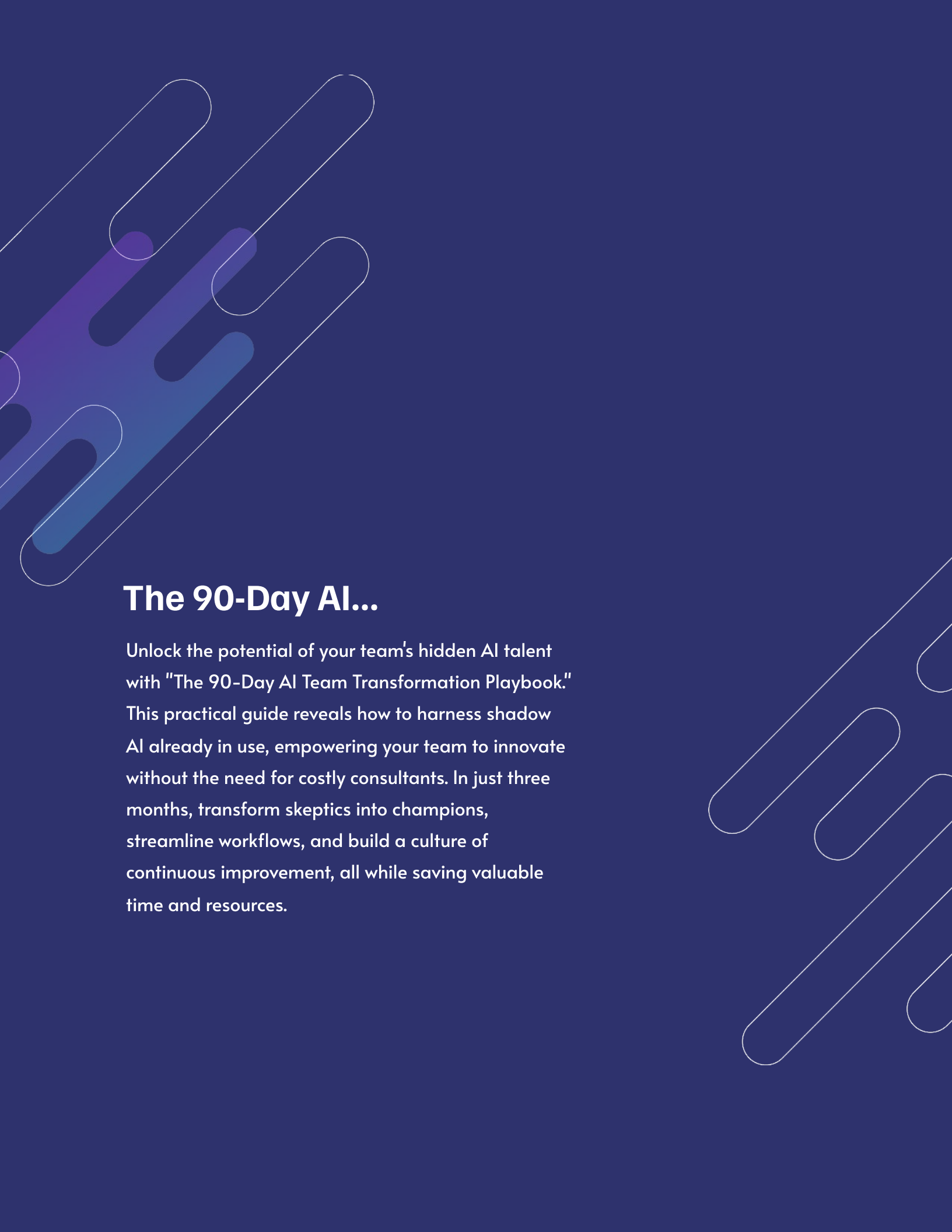
Every Friday, we'll recognize:

- **Person who saved the most time:** Gets flex Friday (leave at 3)
- **Best new automation:** Gets \$100 to try any new AI tool
- **Team that shares most solutions:** Gets team lunch

This isn't mandatory. It's not tracked in performance reviews. It's just us getting smarter about working smarter.

Dashboard goes live Monday. Let's see who can automate away the most boring parts of their job.

Use these. Modify them. Make them yours. Just start.



The 90-Day AI...

Unlock the potential of your team's hidden AI talent with "The 90-Day AI Team Transformation Playbook." This practical guide reveals how to harness shadow AI already in use, empowering your team to innovate without the need for costly consultants. In just three months, transform skeptics into champions, streamline workflows, and build a culture of continuous improvement, all while saving valuable time and resources.